Design History File Review Rubric

Criterion	Weight	Below Expectations (<50%)	Marginal (50-75%)	Meets Expectations (75-90%)	Exceeds Expectations (90-100%)
Currency and completeness	15	Major recent work or required records absent; current state cannot be determined.	Some recent work recorded, but important gaps or stale documents remain.	Records are current and cover relevant design, analysis, meetings, planning, implementation, and verification for the stage.	Exceptionally complete without clutter; current state and history are immediately evident.
Organization and accessibility	15	Repository/files inaccessible or disorganized; files cannot be interpreted.	Structure is partly usable but naming, versions, links, or context cause friction.	Consistent structure, meaningful names, dates/revisions, working files/links, and adequate explanatory context.	Navigation is exceptionally efficient and supports rapid independent review.
Traceability and decision rationale	25	Important requirements, decisions, and changes cannot be traced to evidence.	Some decisions are documented, but connections among needs, inputs, outputs, risks, evidence, and feedback are incomplete.	Major decisions and changes trace coherently to evidence, analysis, stakeholder input, risks, or feedback.	Traceability reveals a rigorous, transparent chain of engineering judgement across iterations.
Technical evidence and reproducibility	20	Technical files are missing, unreliable, unexplained, or unusable.	Evidence exists but lacks context, assumptions, interpretation, or sufficient detail to reproduce.	Calculations, models, code, drawings, data, tests, and results are interpretable and reproducible where appropriate.	Evidence is rigorous, well annotated, and reusable by a technically informed successor.
Iteration and adaptive planning	10	Superseded or failed work is hidden and planning does not respond to project	Some iteration and planning are documented, but responses to setbacks, feedback, or changing	Preserves iterations and failed approaches; current planning shows progress, next steps, and reasoned adaptation to evidence and	Uses design history and progression evidence insightfully to anticipate change and adapt project

		evidence.	constraints are inconsistent.	feedback.	strategy.
Team process, interpersonal relationships, and situational leadership	15	Team interactions materially obstruct progress; responsibilities are avoided or imposed; conflict is ignored or handled inappropriately; leadership is absent or concentrated without regard to project needs.	The team generally functions, but role clarity, shared responsibility, conflict management, escalation, or leadership transitions are inconsistent and sometimes impair progress.	Team members manage working relationships constructively, allocate and renegotiate roles transparently, share responsibility, resolve or appropriately escalate conflict, and shift leadership as expertise and project needs change. Claims are supported by traceable evidence such as meeting records, role allocation, decisions, and documented responses to interpersonal or coordination challenges.	The team deliberately cultivates trust, accountability, and inclusive participation; anticipates and resolves relationship risks; and uses fluid, well-judged leadership transitions that measurably improve decisions, integration, and team performance. Evidence shows how the team learned from interpersonal challenges and strengthened its way of working.